



**THREAT ADVISORY**

**ACTOR  
REPORT**

# Vice Society actors target K-12 institutions in US

Date of Publication

September 7, 2022

Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2022194

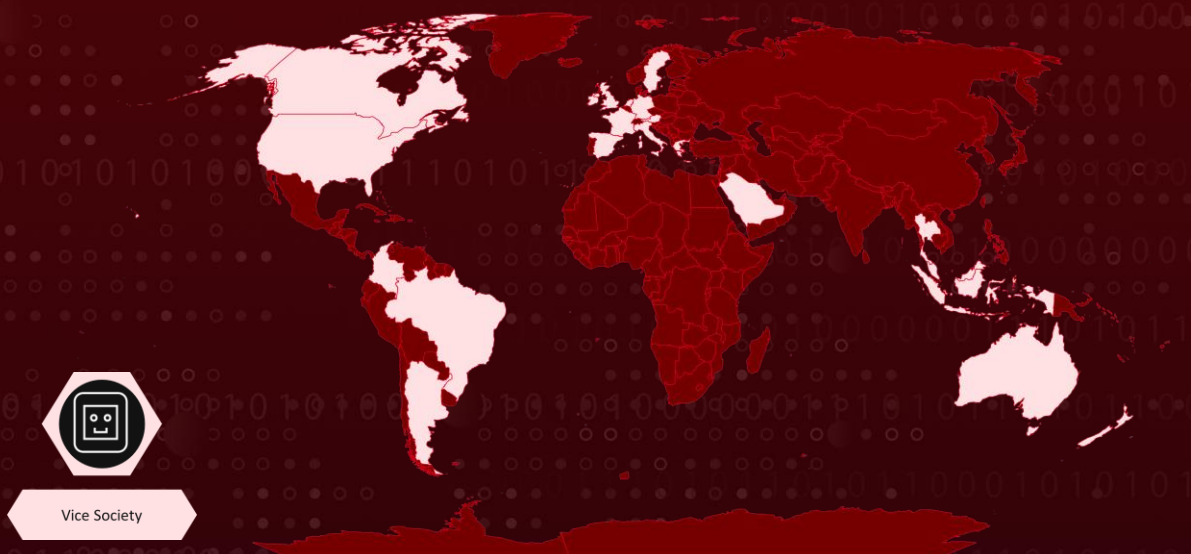
# Summary

Vice Society is an extortion hacking group that emerged in the summer of 2021. The Vice Society does not use a specific ransomware variant. Instead, they used variants of Hello Kitty, Five Hands, and Zeppelin ransomware.

## ⚙️ CVEs Table

| CVE            | NAME                                                             | PATCH |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| CVE-2021-1675  | Windows Print Spooler<br>Elevation of Privilege<br>Vulnerability | ✓     |
| CVE-2021-34527 | Windows Print Spooler<br>Remote Code Execution<br>Vulnerability  | ✓     |

## 🗺️ Actor Map



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# Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

|                                                        |                                                   |                                                 |                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TA0001</b><br>Initial Access                        | <b>T1190</b><br>Exploit Public-Facing Application | <b>T1078</b><br>Valid Accounts                  | <b>TA0010</b><br>Exfiltration                     |
| <b>TA0040</b><br>Impact                                | <b>T1486</b><br>Data Encrypted for Impact         | <b>T1531</b><br>Account Access Removal          | <b>TA0002</b><br>Execution                        |
| <b>T1047</b><br>Windows Management Instrumentation     | <b>TA0008</b><br>Lateral Movement                 | <b>T1080</b><br>Taint Shared Content            | <b>TA0004</b><br>Privilege Escalation             |
| <b>T1068</b><br>Exploitation for Privilege Escalation  | <b>TA0003</b><br>Persistence                      | <b>T1053</b><br>Scheduled Task/Job              | <b>T1547</b><br>Boot or Logon Autostart Execution |
| <b>T1547.001</b><br>Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder | <b>T1547.002</b><br>Authentication Package        | <b>T1543</b><br>Create or Modify System Process | <b>T1543.003</b><br>Windows Service               |
| <b>TA0005</b><br>Defense Evasion                       | <b>T1036</b><br>Masquerading                      | <b>T1055</b><br>Process Injection               | <b>T1497</b><br>Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion    |

# Technical Details

#1

To gain initial network access, the adversary uses compromised credentials obtained from public-facing applications. The actors use a range of tools, including SystemBC, PowerShell Empire, and Cobalt Strike, to traverse across the network and elevate privileges and exfiltrate data before deploying ransomware.

#2

Additionally, the actors have been seen leveraging the PrintNightmare vulnerabilities(CVE-2021-1675 and CVE-2021-34527) to escalate privileges and target the legitimate Windows Management Instrumentation (WMI) service to assist remote access.

#3

To avoid detection, the malware disguises itself as legitimate files. Additionally, dynamic analysis was circumvented with process injection techniques. As a means of avoiding remediation, the actors used domain administrator accounts and scripts to change network accounts' passwords.

## Actor Detail

| NAME         | ORIGIN         | TARGET LOCATIONS                                                                                                  | TARGET INDUSTRIES                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vice Society | Unknown        | Argentina, Austria, Australia, Antigua and Barbuda,                                                               | Construction, Education, Entertainment, Financial Services, Government, Healthcare, Hospitality, Insurance, Professional Services, Manufacturing, Retail, Utilities, Hotels, Pharmaceuticals, Telecommunications |
|              | MOTIVE         | Brazil, Canada, Colombia, France, Germany, Greece, Indonesia, Ireland                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|              | Financial gain | , Italy, Malaysia, New Zealand, Netherlands, Saudi Arabia, Spain, Sweden, Thailand, United Kingdom, United States |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

## Vulnerability Details

| CVE ID         | AFFECTED PRODUCTS                                     | AFFECTED CPE                                                                                        | CWE ID  |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| CVE-2021-1675  | Windows: 7 - 10 and<br>Windows Server: 2008 -<br>2019 | cpe:2.3:o:microsoft:wind<br>ows:-:*:*:*:*:*:*<br>cpe:2.3:o:microsoft:wind<br>ows_server:-:*:*:*:*:* | CWE-269 |
| CVE-2021-34527 | Windows: 7 - 10 and<br>Windows Server: 2008 -<br>2019 | cpe:2.3:o:microsoft:wind<br>ows:-:*:*:*:*:*:*<br>cpe:2.3:o:microsoft:wind<br>ows_server:-:*:*:*:*:* | CWE-269 |

## Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

| TYPE  | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SHA1  | a0ee0761602470e24bcea5f403e8d1e8bfa29832<br>3122ea585623531df2e860e7d0df0f25cce39b21<br>41dc0ba220f30c70aea019de214eccd650bc6f37<br>c9c2b6a5b930392b98f132f5395d54947391cb79 |
| MD5   | fb91e471cfa246beb9618e1689f1ae1d                                                                                                                                             |
| IPV4  | 5.255.99[.]59<br>5.161.136[.]176<br>198.252.98[.]184<br>194.34.246[.]90                                                                                                      |
| URL   | hxxp[:]//vsociethok6sbprvevl4dlwbqrzyhxcxaqpvct5belwvsuxaxsutyard<br>[.]onion                                                                                                |
| Email | v-society.official@onionmail[.]org<br>ViceSociety@onionmail[.]org                                                                                                            |

## 🌀 Patch Links

<https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/en-US/vulnerability/CVE-2021-1675>

<https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/en-US/vulnerability/CVE-2021-34527>

## 🌀 Recent Breaches

<https://www.elmbrookschools.org/>

<https://www.lampton.org.uk/>

<https://francesking.com/>

<https://www.hospicesouthwest.com/>

<https://www.fmclinics.com/>

<https://www.prosol.ca/>

<https://www.csic.es/es>

<https://www.touraine.fr/>

<https://www.vygon.es/>

<https://eden-field.com.au/>

<https://www.slcusd.org/>

<https://www.xquadrat.ag/en/#profile>

<https://alicante.vectalia.es/>

<https://www.pertanian.go.id/>

<https://www.i-med.ac.at/mypoint/>

<https://www.astra-honda.com/>

<https://www.piltoncollege.org.uk/>

<https://www.asst-fbf-sacco.it/>

<https://www.novelty-group.com/>

<https://www.magnum.fr/>

<https://www.gvsu.edu/>

## 🌀 References

<https://www.cisa.gov/uscert/sites/default/files/documents/aa22-249a-stopransomware-vice-society.pdf>

# What Next?

Book a free demo with **HivePro Uni5** to check your exposure to this advisory. HivePro Uni5 is a Continuous Threat Exposure Management Solution that proactively reduces an organization's attack surface before it gets exploited.



At Hive Pro we take a long hard look at your vulnerabilities so you can bolster your defenses and fine-tune your offensive cybersecurity tactics.

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